Rabbia Tariq

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Placement Director: Boon Han koh B.Koh@exeter.ac.uk
PhD Director: Sanchari Roy S.Roy3@exeter.ac.uk

Education

University of Exeter, UK

Ph.D. Economics — 2027 (expected)
MRes. Economics — 2023

Quaid-i-Azam University, Pakistan

MS Economics — 2015

Fields

Applied Microeconomics, Labour Economics, Development Economics

References

Sonia Oreffice	**Mahreen Mahmud**	**Vatsal Khandelwal**
University of Exeter	University of Exeter	University of Exeter
S.Oreffice@exeter.ac.uk	M.Mahmud@exeter.ac.uk	V.Khandelwal@exeter.ac.uk

Job Market Paper

The Withholding Edge: Strategic Sharing of Labour Market Information *(AEA Registry)*

Abstract: Online job platforms have made information about existing opportunities widely accessible, but information about screening processes remains scarce despite its potential significance for labour market outcomes. This paper studies the availability, demand, and diffusion of this *process information*, access to which creates an information advantage. Only 15.5% of vacancy postings on a large job platform mention any assessment stage. An incentive-compatible Becker–DeGroot–Marschak demand elicitation experiment shows that job seekers bid an average of 56% of their budget for process information. In a lab-in-the-field experiment, job seekers are told about real paid jobs while information advantage is randomised. Among 758 vacancy-sharing ties involving sharer with information advantage, 27% withhold the process information. To disentangle the competitive and social incentives, I cross-randomise information advantage with a competition reminder and with the observability of the sharer's identity to recipients. The reminder reduces process information sharing by 35% relative to a 43.2% baseline, while observability increases vacancy sharing among those without information advantage but has no detectable effect on process information sharing. Sharing also follows pre-existing friendships. When crucial information is scarce and access depends on network position, the unequal access may exacerbate existing inequalities and cause labour market misallocation.

Working Paper

Women Appointed to Corporate Boards: Network Centrality and the Gender Quota Reform

Abstract: This study examines the influence of network centrality on first-time board appointments in France, focusing on the impact of the gender quota reform of 2010. Using BoardEx data on executives from publicly listed French firms (2001-2019), I construct professional network measures (degree and betweenness) of executives using their employment history. The findings show that while network centrality does not predict board appointments, it plays a greater role for women post-reform, suggesting that increased visibility may help overcome gender barriers. This study contributes to research on networks, corporate governance, and gender quotas by highlighting how legislative changes shape career advancement in leadership.

Work in Progress

Stereotypes and Effort Provision in Teams

(with H. Ahmed, J. Lamb and A. McCrea) – Data collection ongoing

Abstract: Effort provision in teamwork can be influenced by stereotypes, particularly in remote work settings where individuals collaborate across locations. Stereotypes may affect effort based on perceptions of a teammate's capability or beliefs about how capable teammates perceive them. This study explores the impact of stereotypes and beliefs about stereotypes on teamwork effort using an online experiment based on real effort task.

Other work

Fiscal deficit and inflation: New evidence from Pakistan using a bounds testing approach

(with A. Jalil and N. Bibi), Economic Modelling, 2014

The State of Education during the Covid-19 Crisis

Chapter 10: The state of Pakistan's Economy: During the Pandemic and Beyond.

(with F. Sadik), IBA Press, 2021

Teaching

Postgraduate Teaching Associate (PTA)

Development Economics (3rd Year Undergraduate) Module Leads: Surajeet Chakarvarty & Vatsal Khandelwal, University of Exeter	2022–2025
Economic Principles (1st Year Undergraduate) Module Lead: Debbie Du Preez, University of Exeter	2024–2025
Futures and Options (3rd Year Undergraduate) Module Lead: Julian Neira Sanchez, University of Exeter	2022–2023

Lecturer/Teaching Fellow

Microeconomic Theory, Institute of Business Administration, Pakistan	2020–2021
Principles of Microeconomics, Institute of Business Administration, Pakistan	2020–2021
Principles of Macroeconomics, Institute of Business Administration, Pakistan	2020–2021
Monetary Theory, National University of Sciences and Technology, Pakistan	2016–2019
Intermediate Microeconomics, National University of Sciences and Technology, Pakistan	2016–2019
Principles of Microeconomics, National University of Sciences and Technology, Pakistan	2016–2019
Principles of Macroeconomics, National University of Sciences and Technology, Pakistan	2016–2019

Research visit

Cheti Nicoletti, University of York	Feb 2024

Research Assistant

For Surajeet Chakarvarty, University of Exeter	Nov–Dec 2024
For Julian Dyer, University of Exeter	Jul–Sep 2023
For Christos Kotsogiannis, Tax Administration Research Center (TARC), Exeter	May–Sep 2022
For Abdul Jalil, Pakistan Institute of Development Economcis (PIDE), Pakistan	2019–2020

Workshops & Conferences

2026

Annual Minority in Economics Mentoring Workshop, Bristol; 3rd Annual Behavioural and Experimental Economics (BEE) UK Conference, Exeter *(Poster)*; Symposium on Economic Experiments in Developing Countries (SEEDEC), Durham; Third Annual Workshop on Behavioural Economics, Sheffield; Second South West Economics PhD Conference, Exeter; Post-graduate Research (PGR) Workshop, Exeter

2025

First South West Economics PhD Conference, Exeter; 38th Irish Economic Association Annual Conference, Belfast; Post-graduate Research (PGR) Workshop, Exeter

2024

2nd Diversity and Human Capital Workshop, Exeter *(Lightning talk)*; Post-graduate Research (PGR) Workshop, Exeter

2021

First International Conference on Economics & Sustainable Development, Karachi, Pakistan

Academic Service

Referee

Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics	2024–2025
LABOUR: Review of Labour Economics and Industrial Relations	2026

PhD Student Representative

Department of Economics, University of Exeter	2024–Present

Volunteer

3rd Annual Behavioural and Experimental Economics (BEE) UK Conference, Exeter	2026
Diversity and Human Capital Workshop, University of Exeter	2023–2026
Development Economics Workshop, University of Exeter	2026

Organisation & Coordination

Economics Research Seminar Series, Institute of Business Administration, Pakistan	2020–2021
Faculty sponsor for NUST Economics Society (NES)	2017–2019
PhD Economics Coordination, National University of Sciences & Technology, Pakistan	2016–2019

Research Grants

£1237, Research Allowance for Data Collection, University of Exeter Business School	2025–2026
£3,500, Research Allowance for Data Collection, University of Exeter Business School (joint with Joel Lamb & Ashley McCrea)	2025–2026

Fellowships & Awards

PhD Studentship (MRes + PhD), University of Exeter Business School	2021–2026
Postgraduate Teaching Associate of the Year, University of Exeter Business School	2023
Maximum Rating in Student Evaluation, Institute of Business Administration, Pakistan	2021
Chancellor's Gold Medal, Quaid-e-Azam University, Pakistan	2015
M.Phil. Fellowship, Quaid-e-Azam University, Pakistan	2013–2015

Languages

English *(proficient)*; Urdu *(native)*

Software skills

Stata (*proficient*); R (*proficient*); LaTeX (*proficient*); Python (*competent*); MATLAB (*beginner*)

Other tools: Qualtrics, Git, oTree